1. Website's General Look

Before

- The original HTML pages mainly relied on basic HTML formatting.
- The pages had limited visual styling.
- Elements were quite plain, and there was little visual consistency between sections.
- The website did not have a strong vintage record-store identity.

After

- A consistent **vintage record-store theme** was applied across the website.
- Brown, cream, and gold colors were used throughout the design.
- Shadows, borders, textures, animations, and hover effects were added.
- The overall appearance was changed to resemble an old-fashioned music store combined with a vintage newspaper/magazine style.

Explanation

'CSS' – I created a common style in the CSS instead of styling every element in every HTML page. This makes the website look like one complete website instead of separate pages with different designs.

2. Typography and Fonts

Before

- The original HTML did not have a consistent typography system.
- Text mainly depends on the browser's default styling or individual HTML formatting.

After

- Serif fonts such as **Georgia** and **Times New Roman** were introduced.
- Headings were made larger and more prominent.
- Paragraphs were given a newspaper/magazine appearance.
- Navigation text was made bold and more noticeable.

Reasons.

I used serif fonts which are traditionally associated with newspapers, magazines, and vintage print media. This ties in with the overall vintage theme of The Vinyl Stoep. The typography hierarchy also makes it easier to distinguish headings from normal information.

3. Page Background

Before

- Some pages used a simple background color such as chocolate.
- The background did not have much texture or visual depth.

After

- A cream/paper-colored background was introduced.
- A subtle repeating gradient was used to imitate paper texture.
- The background was combined with dark brown text to create a vintage appearance.

Explanation

Instead of using a completely flat color, I created a CSS paper texture using repeating-linear-gradient. This gives the page the appearance of an aged piece of paper without needing an additional image file.

4. Header

Before

- The header was relatively basic.
- There was little separation between the header and the rest of the page.

After

- A dark brown gradient was added to the header.
- A gold border was placed along the bottom.
- A shadow was added below the header.
- A slide-down animation was added.

Explanation

A dark brown header is a strong contrast to the lighter page. The gold border adds to the vintage luxury feel, and the shadow separates the header from the main content.

5. Logo

Before

- The logo was displayed but had limited styling.
- Its position and appearance were mostly controlled through HTML.

After

- The logo was centered.
- Its size was standardized.
- A floating animation was added.
- A fade-in effect was added.
- A hover effect enlarges the logo slightly and creates a gold glow.

Explanation

The logo was turned into a stronger branding element. The animation makes it feel more interactive without making the website excessively animated.

6. Navigation Links

Before

- Navigation links were mostly basic text links.
- There was little interaction when the user moved the mouse over them.

After

- Navigation was centered.
- Links were given a golden-yellow color.
- Bold serif typography was applied.
- Padding and spacing were added.
- Hover effects were introduced.

- Links move slightly upward when hovered.
- A gold glow effect was added.

Explanation

The navigation was redesigned to make it easier to identify and interact with. The hover animation provides immediate visual feedback when the user places the mouse over a link.

7. Main Content Area

Before

- Content was positioned using the basic HTML layout.
- There was less control over the width and spacing of the content.

After

- The main content was given a controlled width.
- A maximum width of 1350px was introduced.
- The content was centered.
- Consistent padding was added.
- A slide-up animation was applied.

Solution Explanation

I made a standard content area so that the text and images don't spread out for no reason on the screen. This improves readability and gives the website a more organized layout.

8. Main Headings

Before

- Headings were primarily displayed according to the default HTML styling.
- There was less visual hierarchy between headings.

After

- h1, h2 and h3 were individually styled.
- Main headings were enlarged.

- Headings were centered.
- Gold effects were added.
- h3 headings received gold borders.
- Animations were added to the headings.

Explanation

I created a hierarchy so visitors can immediately understand which text represents the page title, section title, and subsection. This also makes sections such as **Featured Artists**, **New Arrivals** and **Limited Edition** stand out.

9. Paragraphs — Newspaper/Magazine Effect

Before

- Paragraphs were mostly plain text.
- There was little visual separation between different pieces of information.

After

- Paragraphs received cream-colored backgrounds.
- Thin gold borders were added.
- Shadows were added.
- A subtle paper texture was introduced.
- Paragraphs have rounded visual spacing and hover effects.

Explanation

I designed the paragraphs to look like pieces of vintage printed material. This is particularly useful for the **About Us**, **Gallery,** and informational sections because it makes large amounts of text more visually interesting.

10. Drop Caps

Before

- Paragraphs started with normal-sized letters.

After

- Important paragraphs have a larger first letter.
- The first letter is bold and gold brown.
- The letter floats beside the rest of the paragraph.

Explanation

This is a **drop-cap effect**, commonly found in newspapers, magazines, and old books. I used it to strengthen the vintage editorial appearance of the website.

11. Product Details Images

Before

- Product images were mainly displayed according to their HTML dimensions.
- There was less consistency between the images.

After

- Product images were given a consistent width of approximately 300px.
- Images were centered.
- Borders were added.
- Gold outlines were introduced.
- Shadows were added.
- Images received animation effects.

Explanation

The purpose was to make the album/product section look like a professionally organized record catalogue. Standardizing the image presentation also prevents individual images from making the page layout inconsistent.

12. Product Image Hover Effects

Before

- Moving the mouse over an image produced little or no visual effect.

After

- Images move slightly upwards.
- Images become slightly larger.
- Sepia effects are applied.
- Saturation, contrast and brightness are adjusted.
- Gold outlines and shadows appear.

Explanation

I created a subtle **vintage image effect**. The sepia filter reinforces the record-store aesthetic while the movement and glow make the images feel interactive.

13. Product Information

Before

- Artist and album information were mainly plain text underneath the images.

After

- Product headings were centered.
- Maximum widths were introduced.
- Cream backgrounds were added.
- Gold borders were introduced.
- Hover effects were added.

Explanation

The information was visually connected to the album image above it. This makes each product feel like an individual catalogue entry rather than simply being a picture followed by plain text.

14. Product Information Cards

Before

- Product descriptions did not have strong visual separation.

After

- Descriptions were placed inside cream-colored areas.
- Gold borders were added.
- Dark brown borders were used for emphasis.
- Shadows were added.
- Hovering over the description slightly lifts the element.

Explanation

This creates a card-like appearance around product descriptions. It helps separate one album's information from another and makes the page easier to scan.

15. New Arrivals and Limited Edition

Before

- The product images were displayed more vertically.
- There was not strong distinction between different product groups.

After

- **New Arrivals** and **Limited Edition** were separated into their own sections.
- Their images were designed to work as a horizontal collection.
- The styling maintains the same borders, shadows, and vintage effects.

Explanation

I differentiated the later product categories from the main featured products so that customers can recognise different sections of the record catalogue more easily.

16. Large Images and Banners

Before

- Large images such as the banner were displayed with basic sizing.

After

- Large images were given controlled widths and heights.
- object-fit: cover was used.
- Dark borders and shadows were added.
- Hover zoom and vintage filter effects were introduced.

Explanation

object-fit: cover allows an image to fill its designated area while maintaining its proportions. The border and shadow make large images look more like designed visual features rather than ordinary HTML images.

17. General Links

Before

- Links mainly used basic browser styling.

After

- Links were given dark brown text.
- Bold typography was applied.
- Underlines were removed.
- Hover effects were introduced.

Explanation

This creates consistency between normal links and the rest of the vintage design. It also prevents the browser's default blue-and-underlined links from conflicting with the color scheme.

18. Call-to-Action Links

Before

- Important links such as "Learn More About Us" appeared as ordinary links.

After

- Important links were redesigned to look like buttons.
- Dark chocolate backgrounds were used.
- Gold text and borders were added.
- Shadows and hover animations were introduced.

Explanation

I made important actions visually stand out so visitors can easily recognize where they can find additional information.

19. Contact Page Sections

Before

- Contact information was mainly presented as standard text.

After

- Contact headings received additional spacing.
- Gold borders were added.
- Typography was made consistent with the rest of the website.

Explanation

The contact information was styled to feel like part of the same website instead of looking like an unformatted block of text.

20. FAQ Page

Before

- Questions and answers were mainly plain text.
- The FAQ page had limited visual separation.

After

- FAQ content was centered.
- A maximum width was applied.
- Font size and spacing were adjusted.
- The FAQ styling was made consistent with the website.

Explanation

Limiting the width prevents long lines of text from becoming difficult to read. The centered layout also makes the FAQ page cleaner and easier to navigate.

21. Video

Before

- The video was displayed with basic HTML dimensions.

After

- The video was centered.
- A dark border was added.
- A shadow was added.
- Hover movement and scaling were introduced.
- A glow effect was added.

Explanation

The video was treated as another visual component of the website instead of simply being embedded media. This keeps it consistent with the interactive image elements.

22. Footer

Before

- The footer had basic information and limited styling.

After

- A dark brown gradient was added.
- Cream text was used.
- A gold top border was introduced.
- Shadows were added.
- Text was centered.
- Letter spacing was adjusted.

Explanation

The footer was designed to visually close the page and mirror the dark header. This creates a consistent beginning and ending to each page.

23. Additional Website Branding

Before

- There was no additional decorative branding behind the main content.

After

- The words **"THE VINYL STOEP"** were added using a CSS pseudo-element.
- The text is centered and faded into the background.

Explanation

I used CSS-generated content rather than adding another HTML element. This creates subtle branding without interfering with the actual content of the page.

24. Scrollbar

Before

- The browser's default scrollbar was used.

After

- The scrollbar was customized to fit the brown/gold website color scheme.

Explanation

Although the scrollbar is a small part of the website, customizing it helps maintain visual consistency beyond the main content area.

25. Text Selection

Before

- Text selection used in the browser's default highlight color.

After

- Text selection was customized to match the website's color scheme.

Explanation

This is a small visual enhancement that helps maintain the site's branding even when the visitor highlights text.

26. Animations

Before

- The original pages had little or no animation.

After

Several CSS animations were introduced, including:

- page Fade
- slide Down
- slide Up
- fade In
- float
- gold Glow
- image Appear
- gentle Pulse

Explanation

The animations were used to make the website feel more dynamic. They were designed to be relatively subtle so that the website remains a vintage record store rather than becoming overly futuristic or cyberpunk.

27. Hover Animations

Before

- Images, links, and other elements had little interaction when the mouse was placed over them.

After

- Images zoom slightly.
- Images move upward.
- Navigation links move upward.
- Shadows become stronger.
- Gold glows appear.
- The logo becomes slightly larger.
- Buttons lift when hovered.

Explanation

Hover effects were added to give users feedback when interacting with the website. The effects also make the website feel more modern while the colors and typography preserve the vintage style.

28. Responsive Design

Before

- The original HTML was primarily designed around a standard desktop layout.
- There was limited adaptation for smaller screens.

After

- Media queries were added for screens below 900px and 600px.
- Navigation links adjust their size and arrangement.
- Headings become smaller.
- Paragraph widths change.
- Product images adapt to smaller screens.
- Mobile navigation becomes vertically arranged.

Explanation

The responsive CSS allows the website to adjust to different screen sizes. This means the website can remain usable on desktops, tablets and mobile phones rather than only being designed for one screen size.

29. Overall Result

Before

The original HTML provided the **structure and content** of the website, including:

- Navigation
- Headings
- Paragraphs
- Images

- Product information
- Contact information
- FAQ content
- Gallery content
- Video
- Links

However, much of the visual appearance was basic and depended on simple HTML formatting or limited inline styling.

After

The CSS transformed that existing HTML structure into a more complete **vintage record-store website design** by adding:

- A consistent brown, cream and gold color palette
- Vintage paper textures
- Newspaper/magazine-style paragraphs
- Drop caps
- Styled headings
- Centered navigation
- Animated logo
- Image hover effects
- Product cards
- Shadows and borders
- Gold highlights
- Buttons and call-to-action styling
- Video styling
- Footer styling
- Page transitions
- Responsive layouts
- Additional branding
- Custom scrollbar and text selection

Explanation

The main purpose of the CSS changes was to **separate the website's content from its presentation**. Instead of repeatedly adding styling directly into each HTML page, the shared CSS file controls the common appearance of the website. This makes the website more

consistent and also makes future changes easier because a style can be changed in one CSS file rather than modifying every HTML page individually.

Overall, the original HTML established **what the website contains**, while the CSS establishes **how that content looks, behaves and responds to the user**.